

Segment 31 Campsite 15 (Craig Lake State Park) to Craig Lake Parking

(Formerly Segment 28), Updated April 2026 [Google Map of Segment 31](#) The Google Map is only for an overview of the trail. **Use Avenza Maps for actually locating and following the trail.**

Trail Adopter: Rick Duemling rduemling@gmail.com (810) 300-4754

Segment length: About 3.65 miles, east to west 366 ft of ascent, 351 ft of descent

Link to [Avenza Maps Online](#) Use Map # 33 in Avenza Maps. Make sure you have the current updates for Avenza. Always refer to the updated Avenza Maps for the most current NCT mile markers.

Please contact mac@northcountrytrail.org or the Trail Adopter above with reports of trail conditions, including blowdowns, washouts or inadequate blazing, or if you have questions on driving directions to the start point.

Many of the backroads have multiple names depending on which map you are using. When known, multiple names for the same road have been indicated in italics within brackets.

On the trail: (all trail descriptions will be westbound, follow in reverse for eastbound)

Craig Lake State Park is Michigan's most remote state park, a wilderness with rustic campsites, cabins and yurts for rent. With the rugged terrain, lakes, and rivers, it's a beautiful area to hike and a peaceful place to get away from everything!

The segment begins at Campsite 15 (46.625725,-88.157745), within Craig Lake State Park and ends at the southern tip of Craig Lake (46.599304,-88.185846). From there you will need to hike about .2 miles to reach the parking area.

Driving Directions

Eastern Trailhead:

The eastern trailhead is not reachable via vehicle. While backcountry maps may show some two tracks nearby, they are located on gated and private land and should not be attempted for parking purposes.

Western Trailhead:

Turn north from US 41 west of Michigamme at the sign to Craig Lake State Park at (46.540168,-88.134749). The roughly 7 mile trip is well signed. At 1.2 miles, stay left at the Y. Continue another 1.4 miles and go straight (do not turn towards the Keewaydin Lake Yurt). Continue another 3.9 miles and turn right into the parking area at (46.599485,-88.189898). For those who prefer to follow a Google Map, here is the [Driving Map US41 to Craig Lake State Park parking](#). Please be sure to read Seasonal Access Information below. A Michigan Recreation Pass is required for your vehicle. [How and where to purchase a Michigan Recreation Passport](#)

Camping:

Craig Lake State Park backcountry campsites will be by reservation only starting in 2023. [Backcountry reservations at Craig Lake State Park](#) Camping season runs from May 20 through November 1. All overnight backpackers will be required to make a backcountry reservation for a specific campsite. Dispersed camping is not allowed. Long distance NCNST hikers can call Van Riper State Park Campground Office at (906) 339-4461 prior to their hike to inform the DNR that they are traveling through and DNR staff can check them in. Hikers will be allowed to print reservation papers and have them available should a backcountry ranger ask to see them.

Water Access:

Water is available along Craig Lake and at various water crossings.

Seasonal Access Information:

From late spring through early winter a higher clearance vehicle is necessary to reach the western trailhead. This is a very rough road which can be flooded in the spring or after rain. The condition of the road is frequently addressed on the Craig Lake State Park Facebook page at <https://www.facebook.com/CraigLakeSP/> or you can attempt to reach someone at (906) 339-4461. The trailhead is not reachable via vehicle in the wintertime.